

NAVIGATION

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01

Brand Identity

Who we are, what we stand for, and how we speak.

Mission Statement

WorkforceAP is the operating system for workforce development — connecting underserved adults, the organizations that serve them, and the employers that need them, in one verified closed loop.

Brand Positioning

Attribute	WorkforceAP Is	WorkforceAP Is Not
Access	Free to all qualifying members, no prerequisites	Employer-sponsored only
Audience	Adults 18+ at any career stage	Recent grads or college students only
Outcome	Verified placement, 180-day tracking	Certificate mill with no job guarantee
Technology	Full-stack platform with AI tools	PDF worksheets and email chains

Brand Personality

- Grounded

We don't over-promise. We show outcomes.
- Direct

Plain language. No jargon. No "unlock your potential."
- Warm but serious

Empathetic tone — this is someone's livelihood, not a SaaS demo.
- Ambitious

We're building infrastructure, not a nonprofit website.
- Inclusive

No age gate. No degree. No exclusion language.

02

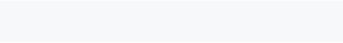
Color System

The primary palette, accent usage rules, and semantic colors.

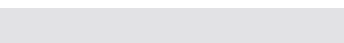
Primary Palette

			
Crimson (Accent) #AD2C4D CTAs, links, accents, hero badges	Gold #FFBB00 Dark backgrounds only — never on light surfaces	Near Black #121416 Hero backgrounds, dark surfaces	White #FFFFFF Primary text on dark, light surfaces

Supporting Palette

			
Accent Dark #8B1F38 Hover states for crimson	Accent Light #FFB2BC Light mode subtle tints	Blue #2B7BB9 Links, informational states	Green #4A9B4F Success states, positive metrics
			
On Surface #1C1B1B Body text on light backgrounds	On Surface Var. #584144 Secondary text, labels, captions	Surface Low #F7F8FA Page background (light mode)	Gray 200 #E8E8E8 Borders, dividers

Dark Mode Palette

			
Background #121416 Page background	Surface #1A1C1E Cards, containers	Surface High #282A2C Elevated elements	On Surface #E2E2E5 Primary text on dark
			
On Surface Var. #DEBFC2 Secondary text, labels	Accent (same) #AD2C4D CTAs remain same crimson	Gold (same) #FFBB00 Gold — reads well on dark	Outline #584144 Borders on dark surfaces

Color Usage Rules

- ✓ **DO** Use Crimson (#AD2C4D) as the sole CTA color — buttons, links, accents.
- ✓ **DO** Use Gold (#FFBB00) on dark backgrounds only (heroes, dark cards, stat numbers).
- ✓ **DO** Maintain 4.5:1 contrast ratio for body text, 3:1 for large text (18px+).
- ✓ **DO** Use CSS tokens (var(--color-accent)) — never hardcode hex values in new code.
- ✗ **DON'T** Use Gold on white or light gray backgrounds — fails WCAG contrast.
- ✗ **DON'T** Use hardcoded #fcf9f8, #1c1b1b, #584144 in new code — use CSS variables.

✗ DON'T Add new colors without updating the design system.

✗ DON'T Use red for non-error states or green for non-success states.

03

Typography

Inter is our single typeface. Hierarchy through weight and size, not font switching.

Primary Typeface: Inter

Inter is a typeface carefully crafted for computer screens. It features a tall x-height, clean forms, and excellent readability at all sizes.

Type Scale

Display / H1 40px / Bold 700 Page heroes, major headlines

Empowering People. Advancing Futures.

H2 32px / Bold 700 Section titles

Industry-Recognized Certifications

H3 24px / Bold 700 Card titles, subsections

Digital Literacy Program

H4 20px / Bold 700 Labels, emphasized body

Program Requirements

Body 16px / Regular 400 All paragraph text, 45-75 chars/line

WorkforceAP provides free career training to adults at every stage of their journey.

Small / Caption 14px / Regular 400 Metadata, labels, legal text

Program duration: 3-6 months • Cost to member: \$0

Typography Rules

Line Height Body: 1.6x • Headings: 1.1–1.2x

Max Line Width	65–70 characters (max-width: ~680px on body text)
Font Weight	Regular (400) for body, Bold (700) for headings and CTAs — no 500/600 in headlines
Letter Spacing	Headings: -0.02em to -0.04em • Labels: +0.06em to +0.1em • Never on body
Orphans	Use text-wrap: balance on headings ≤3 lines
Numbers	Use tabular-nums on salary ranges, stats, and data tables

04

Spacing & Layout

An 8px base grid. Consistent scale. No arbitrary values.

Spacing Scale (8px base)

Token	Value	Usage
--space-1	4px	Icon padding, tight badge gaps
--space-2	8px	Compact padding inside small elements
--space-3	12px	Internal card padding (mobile)
--space-4	16px	Standard gap, button padding
--space-6	24px	Section element gaps
--space-8	32px	Card padding, large gaps
--space-12	48px	Section padding (mobile)
--space-16	64px	Section padding (desktop)
--space-24	96px	Hero padding, major section spacing

Border Radius

Token	Value	Usage
--radius-sm	4px	Small badges, tags
--radius-md	8px	Buttons, inputs, small cards
--radius-lg	12px	Cards, dropdowns
--radius-xl	16px	Hero cards, modals, prominent containers
--radius-full	50px	Pills, avatar images, fully rounded badges

Breakpoints

Breakpoint	Range	Behavior
Mobile	<640px	Single column, large touch targets (44px+), bottom nav
Tablet	640–1024px	Two-column grid, sidebar collapses
Desktop	1024–1440px	Full layout, multi-column grids
Wide	>1440px	Capped at --max-width, centered

06

Buttons & CTAs

One primary action per view. Consistent hierarchy.

Button Hierarchy

Primary #AD2C4D bg, white text, 700 weight
One per screen. Main conversion action (Apply, Start, Submit).

Secondary / Outline Transparent bg, accent border+text
Supporting actions (Learn More, Compare, View Details).

Ghost Transparent, muted text, subtle border
Tertiary actions, destructive caution, nav items.

Disabled Reduced opacity (0.5), not-allowed cursor
Unavailable actions — always include tooltip explaining why.

Icon + Text Material Symbol left of label
Download, Share, Add — icon reinforces action meaning.

CTA Copy Rules

	Copy	Why
✓ DO	Apply for Free	Specific, zero-cost signal, active voice
✓ DO	Start My Application	Personal pronoun, action verb
✓ DO	Compare Programs	Specific, describes what happens next
✗ DON'T	Learn More	Generic — says nothing
✗ DON'T	Click Here	Meaningless, bad for accessibility
✗ DON'T	Submit	Mechanical, impersonal
✗ DON'T	Get Started Today!	Filler urgency, exclamation mark feels desperate

10

Voice & Copy

How WorkforceAP sounds. Plain. Direct. Human.

Tone Principles

Direct, not cold

We say what we mean. No corporate speak. No empty affirmations.

✓ WRITE THIS

""Apply now. We respond within 3–5 business days.""

✗ NOT THIS

""We'd love to connect with you on your exciting journey forward!""

Warm, not soft

This is someone's livelihood. We take it seriously but not grimly.

✓ WRITE THIS

""No cost to you. Ever. Funded by employers and grants.""

✗ NOT THIS

""Our incredible platform empowers you to unlock your true potential!""

Specific, not vague

Use real numbers. Real outcomes. Real certifications.

✓ WRITE THIS

""CompTIA A+ certified. IBM AI Professional. \$62K–\$88K starting range.""

✗ NOT THIS

""Industry-recognized certifications in high-demand fields.""

Inclusive, not exclusive

Never imply a gate. Never use "young professional" or "recent grad."

✓ WRITE THIS

""For adults at any stage of their career.""

✗ NOT THIS

""For recent grads and young professionals entering the workforce.""

Terminology Standards

Member	Program participants. Never "student," "user," or "candidate."
Counselor	WorkforceAP staff supporting members. Not "advisor" or "coach."
Partner	Referring organizations. Not "affiliate" or "vendor."
Employer	Hiring companies. Not "client" or "partner" (different from Partner above).
Certification	Always specific: "CompTIA A+" not "a certification." Never "certificate."

WorkforceAP	One word, camel case. Never "Workforce AP," "WAP," or "WFAP."
Free	Use "free" or "\$0 cost to members" — never "no-cost" or "complimentary."

11

Logo & Photography

Consistent logo usage and authentic imagery standards.

Logo Usage Rules

Clear Space	Minimum clear space = 1x the height of the "W" letterform on all sides.
Minimum Size	120px wide (digital), 1 inch (print). Never smaller.
On Light	Use full-color logo (crimson wordmark + dark icon)
On Dark / Photos	Use white version or icon-only reversed
On Accent	Use white version only
Don't stretch	Always maintain aspect ratio. Never skew, rotate, or add effects.
Don't recolor	Never apply gradient, shadow, or custom color to the logo.
Don't crowd	Never place near other logos without the minimum clear space buffer.

Photography & Imagery Standards

People	Show real adults in professional contexts. Diverse in age, background, and ability. Never stock-photo "business handshake."
Environment	Offices, classrooms, training centers, job sites — contexts where the skills apply.
Overlay	Hero images always get a dark gradient overlay (rgba(18,20,22,0.82)). Never run text directly on an unfiltered photo.
Tone	Warm and purposeful. Avoid cold/clinical or overly staged/aspirational (private jets, mansions).
Certification logos	Always use official logos from Google, IBM, AWS, CompTIA, Microsoft. Never recreate.
AI-generated	Do not use AI-generated images of people. Use authentic photography only.

Quick Reference

The essential rules on one page.

Category	Rule
Primary CTA color	#AD2C4D — Crimson. Always.
Gold usage	Dark backgrounds only. Never on white or light gray.
Body font	Inter, 16px, line-height 1.6, #1C1B1B on light / #E2E2E5 on dark
Heading font	Inter, Bold 700, -0.02em to -0.04em letter-spacing
Spacing base	8px grid. Use CSS tokens (--space-4, --space-8, etc.)
Border radius	Buttons: --radius-md (8px). Cards: --radius-lg (12px). Modals: --radius-xl (16px)
Contrast minimum	4.5:1 body text, 3:1 large text (18px+), 3:1 UI components
Mobile breakpoint	<640px — single column, 44px touch targets, bottom nav
Logo clear space	1x "W" height on all sides. Never <120px wide.
CTA copy	Specific + active voice. "Apply for Free" > "Learn More"
Dark mode	Use CSS var() tokens — never hardcode hex values
Terminology	"Member" not "student." "WorkforceAP" not "WAP." "Free" not "complimentary."

For questions about the brand or design system, contact the WorkforceAP product team. The live design system lives in the [workforceap-beta](#) repository under `css/main.css`.